

INTERNATIONAL news



EV sales accelerating with drop in battery prices

The global battery management system market revenue will be worth US\$22,279.6 million by 2030. The declining prices of automotive batteries, especially lithium-ion batteries, are driving the battery management system market by accelerating the sales of EVs and, in turn, the demand for batteries. Indo-Pacific is the largest battery management system market, and it will also witness the fastest revenue growth in the years to come.

Microcontroller market likely to grow over ten percent annually

The global microcontroller market size is predicted to reach US\$36.16 billion by 2028 at a CAGR of 10.1 percent from 2021 to 2028. Globally, more than 28 billion units of microcontrollers were shipped in 2020. The market growth is attributable to the increasing focus on automation and artificial intelligence across various verticals such as automotive and industrial. Increasing demand for embedded control systems in multi-functional devices such as vehicles, robots, medical devices, mobile radio, residential appliances, among others, is also playing a role in growth of the market.

Shortage of components likely to hit PC monitors production

The PC monitor market grew 16.9 percent year over year with shipments surpassing 39.2 million units, a number last exceeded during the fourth quarter of 2011. For the full year 2020, shipments grew 8.3 percent compared to 2019, according to International Data Corporation (IDC). Looking ahead, IDC expects the present component shortages to last at least through the first half of 2021.

Shortage of chips may increase smartphone prices

Global chip shortage is causing an increase in Chinese smartphone manufacturer Xiaomi's costs, which could, in turn, lead to a rise in the price of their products, the company's CEO Wang Xiang said recently. Chip shortage, initially contained within the automotive industry, has now extended to other hardware sectors as well, smartphones being one of them. Companies like Qualcomm Inc. have been hard-hit by the shortage.

Intel may start making chips for automakers before year end

In light of the existent chip scarcity that has crippled automotive manufacturers all over the world, Intel Corp is in talks to expand its business by producing semiconductor chips for carmakers. Intel CEO Pat Gelsinger announced that they are engaged in discussions with automotive chip designing companies about using Intel's factory network to manufacture those chips within a six to nine months period.

Apple investing in new design centre for wireless semiconductors

Apple is gearing up to open a new design centre in Munich, Germany, which will focus on designing wireless semiconduc-

tors and software. The company intends to invest €1 billion in developing this design centre over the next three years. The new facility, once operational, will be Europe's largest R&D site for mobile wireless semiconductors and software. The company now aims to make Munich its home for European silicon design.

LG shuts down mobile phone business

LG Electronics Inc. (LG) is closing its mobile business unit. The company informed that the decision has been approved by its board of directors. It is not clear if the company will also stop supplying smartphone components like display units to global brands. This, however, looks highly unlikely. The company's mobile phone business has been consistently making losses in the markets.

Qualcomm Ventures invests in Indian electronics brand boAt

Qualcomm Ventures, the investment arm of semiconductor company Qualcomm, has invested in Indian audio electronics brand boAt, an official statement from boAt informed. The company did not reveal the investment amount. In January 2021, boAt had raised approximately US\$100 million from an affiliate of Warburg Pincus, a leading global private equity fund focused on growth investing.

Nvidia to make ARM based processor as direct challenge to Intel

Nvidia Corp is planning to make server processor chip 'Grace' using ARM's technology. This is the most straightforward challenge the processor manufacturing company has ever given to its rival Intel Corp. ARM based chips have been giving tough competition to Intel's products for quite some time now, and with this new server chip taking shape, Nvidia Corp will become its biggest competitor in the chip market yet.

GM and LG to build battery manufacturing plant in USA

Joint venture partners General Motors Co. and LG Energy Solutions announced their plans to build a US\$2.3 billion battery cell manufacturing plant in Spring Hill, Tennessee. This will be their second factory of the kind. GM has earlier said that it would invest US\$2 billion in Spring Hill to build EVs. The Detroit automaker said last year it was investing US\$27 billion in electric and autonomous vehicles over the next five years.

Wise Road Capital acquires Magnachip Semiconductor

Magnachip Semiconductor Corporation has entered into a definitive agreement with South Dearborn Limited, a company incorporated in the Cayman Islands, and Michigan Merger Sub, Inc., a Delaware corporation, which are investment vehicles established by Wise Road Capital Ltd and certain of its limited partners. The all-cash transaction has an equity value of approximately US\$1.4 billion. The transaction is fully backed by equity commitments and not contingent on any financing conditions.